

STANDS IN SOLIDARITY WITH THE PEOPLE OF JAMMU & KASHMIR AND THE ARMED FORCES

THE INSTITUTE OF CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS OF INDIA (ICAI) CELEBRATED THE 79TH INDEPENDENCE DAY IN PAHALGAM, J&K

"Your presence here has a lot of weight... it sends a powerful message of confidence and support. It reflects your belief in this place and reassures our people that better days lie ahead."

— ***Shri Omar Abdullah***
Hon'ble Chief Minister of Jammu & Kashmir

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) celebrated the 79th Independence Day in Pahalgam with the people of Kashmir, standing in solidarity with the Armed Forces and reaffirming its commitment to the citizens of Jammu & Kashmir. In a historic gesture, ICAI also convened its 445th Council Meeting in Pahalgam from August 12–14, becoming the first national institution to host such a high-level meeting in the Valley after the tragic Baisaran incident of April 22.

Over 130 people, including members, their families and children, visited Pahalgam, reflecting ICAI's deep trust in the region and its vision for peace and prosperity in the Valley. ICAI is the first organisation to visit Pahalgam after the recent terrorist attack, sending a clear message that the nation stands united, unafraid and unwavering in its belief that Kashmir will always remain an integral part of India. The large presence generated optimism among the local community, with expectations that such visits would encourage people from across India to come to Pahalgam in large numbers, giving a much-needed boost to tourism. During the three-day meeting, the Council engaged in deliberations on key policy matters of strategic importance to the profession.

"Our presence here reflects hope, resilience, and our pledge to work for peace and prosperity. As financial architects and partners in nation-building, we reaffirm our commitment to economic revival, tourism, and developmental collaborations in Jammu & Kashmir."

— ***CA. Charanjot Singh Nanda***
President, ICAI



"Celebrating Independence Day here and hosting our 445th Council Meeting in Pahalgam is a moment of pride."

— ***CA. Prasanna Kumar D***
Vice-President, ICAI

ICAI also proposed collaborative initiatives with the J&K Government in areas such as cost optimisation, accrual-based accounting for government departments, curriculum development for universities, and accounting reforms for local bodies. In order to support students of the region, ICAI offers a 75% fee waiver on CA Course registration fees for students from Jammu & Kashmir and also plans to set up a Centre of Excellence in the region to boost capacity building, research, and skill development, driving growth in J&K.

On the occasion, ICAI also submitted a report: "From Policy to Profit: Amplifying MSME Revenues in J&K" outlining a five-pillar strategy for MSME growth in the valley. ICAI also announced plans to establish a Centre of Excellence in J&K for capacity building, research, and policy advisory.

As the national anthem echoed in Pahalgam on August 15, ICAI reaffirmed its resolve that Kashmir's spirit remains unbroken and its journey towards peace and prosperity continues.

As a socially responsible institution with 15 lakh members and students, ICAI has consistently supported the nation—from COVID relief, MSME and startup empowerment, and policymaking, to Operation Sindoor and sustainability initiatives.